

DRAWING GRID A drawing grid is made up of a series of squares that enable an artist to transfer a sketch proportionately onto a large-scale support. The grid can easily be produced by drawing squares onto a piece of acetate or tracing paper and then laid over the sketch.

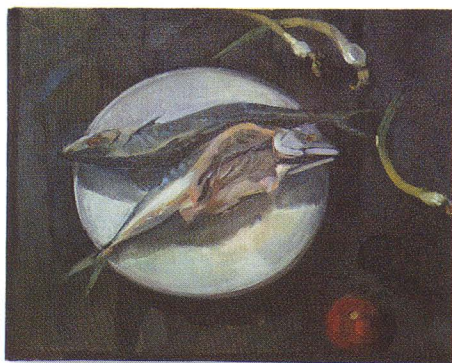
DRY BRUSH TECHNIQUE A method of painting in which paint of a dry or stiff consistency is stroked or rubbed across the canvas. It is picked up on the ridges of the canvas or by the texture of paint on the surface, leaving some of the color on the canvas still visible and producing a broken color effect (*see also* scumbling).

EASEL A frame for holding a painting while the artist works on it. Landscape painters tend to use sketching easels, which are of a light construction. A good sketching easel allows the painting to be held securely in any position from vertical to horizontal. The heavy radial studio easel and vertical studio easel are suitable for studio work.

EXTENDER A pigment which has a limited effect on a color. It may be added to control the properties of a paint or to reduce the cost. Examples are chalk and china clay.



High-key color



Low-key color

FAT-OVER-LEAN The rule applying to oil painting in layers, in which each superimposed layer should have a little more oil in the paint than the one beneath. This ensures that each layer is more flexible as a dried film than the one below it, with less risk of the paint cracking.

FERRULE The metal part of a brush which surrounds and retains the hairs.

FIXATIVE A surface coating which prevents charcoal, chalk, and Conté crayon from becoming dusty and from mixing with overlaid color.

FLAT COLOR An area of matte color of uniform tone and hue.

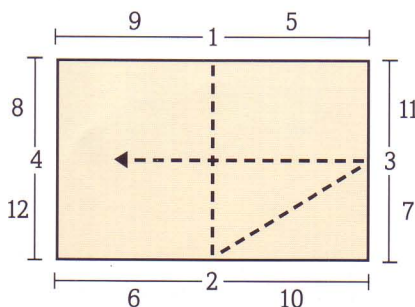
FUGITIVE Colors that are not lightfast and will fade over a period of time.

GESSO A traditional ground for tempera and oil painting on panel comprising animal glue (rabbit skin glue) and plaster of paris. In northern Europe, chalk and glue were used for the same purpose. Not to be confused with the product acrylic gesso (primer), which is also commonly available as a primer for acrylic painting.

GLAZE A film of transparent or translucent oil color laid over another dried color or underpainting. The oil paint is usually mixed with an oil painting medium to make it more malleable.

GROUND The surface on which color is applied. This is usually the coating rather than the support. A colored ground is useful for low-key paintings where the ground provides the halftones and the unifying element for the different colors. A colored ground can also be applied as an imprimatura, or as a primer that has been colored.

HALFTONES Transitional tones between the highlights and the darks.



Stretching a canvas

HATCHING Making tonal gradations by shading with long, thin brushstrokes. Often used in underpainting.

HEEL OF BRUSH The base of the hairs near the ferrule.

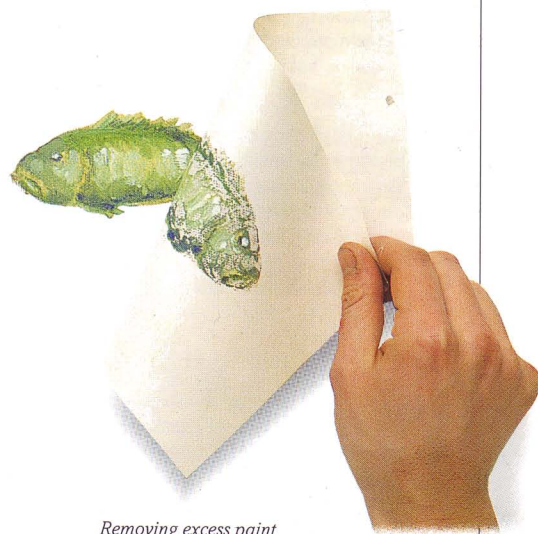
HIGH-KEY COLOR Brilliant and saturated color. Some oil colors, especially the transparent ones, are dark when used directly from the tube, so a little white can be mixed with them to give a saturated color effect. Alternatively, such colors can be used thinly on a white ground for a similar high-key look. High key paintings are usually painted on white or near-white grounds.

HIGHLIGHT The lightest tone in drawing or painting. In oil painting techniques, white constitutes the lightest tone.

HUE Describes the actual color of an object or substance. Its hue may be red, yellow, blue, green, and so on.

IMPASTO A thick layer of paint, often applied with a painting knife or a bristle brush, which is heaped up in ridges to create a heavily textured surface and a look of fresh immediacy. Artists often scrape the paint off the surface of the support and apply the color again if it does not retain the crispness of the effect required.

IMPRIMATURA A thin overall film or stain of translucent color over a white priming. This is applied before the artist begins to paint. It does not affect the reflective qualities of the ground, but it provides a useful background color and makes it easier to paint between the lights and darks. It also allows for an economical style.



Removing excess paint